Responsible Administrator: Provost
Responsible Office: Provost
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Academic Integrity Policy

Policy Statement

The academic community relies upon a high standard of integrity in the relations among its members. To the extent that this standard is not maintained, the good of the community suffers, and injustice may be done.

Purpose of Policy

One of the most important aspects of academic integrity concerns the just measure of each student's academic accomplishments. These are ordinarily evaluated through written examination or submitted work. For such modes of assessment to operate fairly, it is essential that the instructor be assured that the work used to evaluate the student's performance is genuinely the student's own. It is also the responsibility of the student to uphold the academic integrity of the University. The use of unauthorized material, communication with fellow students during an examination, attempting to benefit from the work of another student and similar behavior that defeats the intent of an examination or other class work is unacceptable. Cheating on examinations, plagiarism, improper acknowledgment of sources in essays and the use of a single essay or paper in more than one course without permission are considered very serious offenses and shall be grounds for disciplinary action.

Statement on the Use of Technology Developments and Tools (e.g., Artificial Intelligence)

Regarding developing technologies and tools - such as Artificial Intelligence - faculty members may enact specific policies in their courses, in conformity with this policy and any departmental policies. As a specific example, faculty members should address students' use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) software or applications in their courses. These course-specific policies must be stated in the course syllabus and posted in the University's LMS.

Applicability

This policy applies to students, faculty members, other individuals providing course instruction, and applicable University staff.

Definitions

- **Academic Action**: Measures taken by faculty or academic administrators in response to violations of academic integrity. These actions are directly related to the student's academic performance.
- **Advisor**: An individual chosen by the student to provide support and guidance throughout the academic integrity process. The Advisor may be a faculty or staff member, student, or another representative of the student. The Advisor is not permitted to participate directly or speak for the student.
- **Day**: University business day, not including Saturday, Sunday, any officially recognized university employee holiday, or any day the University is closed.

- **Disciplinary Action**: Non-academic actions imposed by the university's disciplinary or conduct authorities in response to particularly egregious or repeated acts of academic dishonesty. These actions are intended to address behavior that violates the institution's code of conduct.
- **Faculty/Instructor**: An academic supervisor or any person holding a faculty appointment responsible for or authorized to conduct an academic evaluation (i.e., Teacher Assistant).
- **Complainant:** The person alleging a violation of the Academic Integrity Policy. Third parties reporting an incident are not complainants.
- **Appellate**: The individual that determines whether the decision was reasonable based on the Criteria for Student Appeal identified within this policy.

Procedure for Suspected Violations of Academic Integrity

1. Academic Action

Reporting

Anyone with a good faith basis for believing that a student has violated academic integrity may report the alleged violation to the instructor for the course in which the action occurred.

Standard of Information

The standard of information in academic integrity cases is by clear and convincing evidence, which means that the evidence presented must be highly and substantially more probable to be true than not, or the evidence must instantly tilt the scales in the affirmative when weighed against the evidence in opposition.

- If found Not Responsible, the allegation is closed, and no academic actions are imposed.
- If found Responsible, the student will be provided with recommended academic actions.

Steps for Faculty

If a faculty member suspects a violation of academic integrity, the following steps will be taken:

Notification and Right to Respond

1. **Notification**: Within ten (10) business days of discovering the alleged violation, the faculty member will notify the student of the following:
    a. All alleged charges in writing;
    b. All supporting information/documents of alleged charges;
    c. The Academic Integrity Policy;
    d. The student's right to appeal (refer to the current catalog under "Appeal and Change of Final Grade") and
    e. The student's right to schedule a meeting with the faculty member at an agreeable date and time for an Academic Integrity Conference.

No penalty will be imposed until the student has been informed of the charge and given ten (10) business days to respond and present a defense.

2. **Academic Integrity Conference:** The student must be given an opportunity to meet with the faculty member personally. The Academic Integrity Conference aims to allow the student to review the alleged violation(s) with the faculty member, examine the evidence, and discuss the Academic Integrity Policy and the resources available to the student. The Academic Integrity Conference may be held in-person or virtual with the student.

The student is encouraged to seek counsel from their primary advisor or from the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability.

3. **Resolution:** See the Resolution section below.

If the faculty member is unavailable, the Department Head of the course will serve as a proxy and work with the student to resolve the issue. The Department Head will then be identified as the complainant, removing their role as appellate. The student may appeal the Department Head's decision to the Dean of the course involved.

Resolution

1. **Agreement or No Response**: If the student agrees that a violation has occurred, or if there is no response from the student, a lower grade or an "F" may be assigned to the test or assignment or, in the case of a serious violation, to the entire course. This decision is at the instructor's discretion. Agreement or no response cannot be appealed.
2. **Appeal:** Students may appeal the academic action(s) of an Academic Integrity violation on the four (4) criteria identified later in this policy under Criteria for Student Appeal.
3. **Documentation**: A written report (Academic Integrity Instructor's Checklist form) of the action taken must be filed with the Department Head and Dean of the course involved. The Dean will also provide copies of the report to the Dean of the student's major and the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability for record keeping. Records are kept on file at the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability for seven (7) years.
4. **Incomplete Grades**: If a case cannot be resolved before the final grades are due, an "I" (Incomplete) grade will be assigned until the appropriate grade can be determined. If a grade will be withheld for any period, the Dean of the involved course must notify the Registrar's Office.
5. **Course Withdrawal**: Withdrawal from the course does not resolve or dismiss an academic integrity complaint.

2. Appeals Process

Student Appeal: The student will appeal first to the Department Head and then the Dean of the course involved. The Dean's decision is final. The appeal should clearly and concisely describe what occurred and state why the student's activities or behavior should not be determined as academic dishonesty. Students should provide additional information about why the Appellate should grant the appeal. Supporting documentation is allowed and may be included with the appeal.

Criteria for Student Appeal: Appeals must be based on one or more of the following criteria:

- Whether the Academic Integrity process was conducted fairly, without bias, and in conformity with the properly prescribed procedures;
- Whether new evidence, contradictory evidence, or evidence that the student was not afforded due process;
- Whether to consider new information sufficient to alter a decision or other relevant facts not brought out in the original complaint because such information and/or facts were not known to the student objecting at the time of the original complaint and/or
- Whether the academic action or remedy imposed was disproportionate to the gravity and nature of the action.

1. **Student Appeal to the Department Head**: Within ten (10) business days of receiving the faculty member's decision, the student may appeal it to the course Department Head. The Department Head will:
    i. Determine whether the decision was reasonable based on the evidence presented and will have the authority to uphold, modify, or reverse the decision.
    ii. Send their decision in writing to the student and the faculty member within ten (10) business days of receipt of the appeal.
    iii. Provide appropriate documentation (Academic Integrity Department Head's Checklist form) to the dean's office of the course in question and the student's major, and also to the OSAA.

2. **Student Appeal to the Dean:** Within ten (10) business days of receiving the Department Head's decision, the student may appeal it to the Dean, who has administrative authority over the course. The Dean will:
    i. Determine whether the decision was reasonable based on the evidence presented and will have the authority to uphold, modify, or reverse the decision.
    ii. Send their decision in writing to the student, the department head and the faculty member within ten (10) business days of receipt of the appeal.
    iii. Provide appropriate documentation (Academic Integrity Dean's Checklist form) to the dean's office of the course in question and the student's major, and also to the OSAA.

Faculty Appeal: Within ten (10) business days of receiving the Department Head's decision, the faculty member may appeal it to the Dean, who has administrative authority over the course.

3. Final Decision

1. **Appeal Denied:** The original academic action(s) will be imposed if all appeals are denied.
2. **Appeal Approved:** All or some of the original academic action(s) will be modified or reversed.
3. **Documentation**: A written report of the action taken must be filed with the Department Head and Dean of the course involved. The Dean will also provide copies of the report to the Dean of the student's major and the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability for record keeping. Records are kept on file at the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability for seven (7) years.

4. Disciplinary Actions

Disciplinary actions may be imposed in addition to academic actions for particularly egregious or repeated acts of academic dishonesty. Disciplinary actions must originate with the Dean's office; that is, either the Dean of the college of the course involved or the Dean of the college of the student's major. If the Dean believes a violation warrants disciplinary actions such as probation, suspension, or expulsion, they may file a written complaint with the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability. This initiates the procedures outlined in the Code of Student Conduct. Additionally, repeated acts of academic dishonesty may lead to disciplinary procedures initiated by the Dean of the student's major.

The disciplinary process is initiated by filing a formal complaint with the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability, which follows the procedures established in the Student Code of Conduct. Since the Office does not have authority over assignments or course grades, a formal complaint of academic integrity violations must be filed within thirty (30) business days after the procedures outlined in this policy have been followed.

[End of Policy]